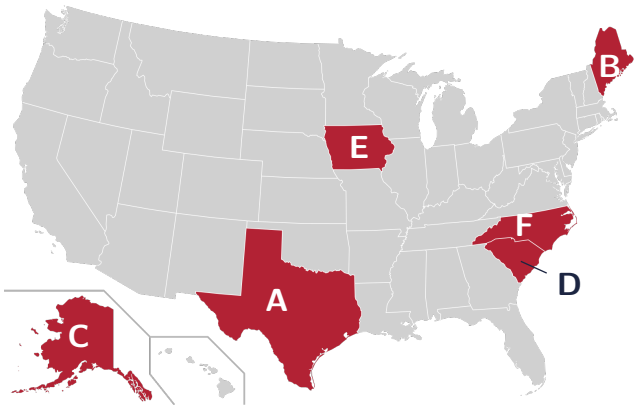
Midterm Results

Six states that changed the Senate



Warm-up

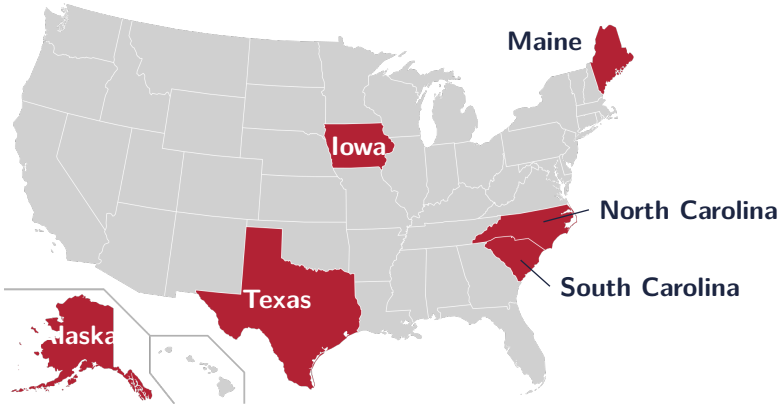
Where are these states?



- Alaska
- Iowa
- Maine
- North Carolina
- South Carolina
- Texas

Match the letters

The six states



All six: a Republican seat

The game

When did each state last elect a **Democratic** senator?

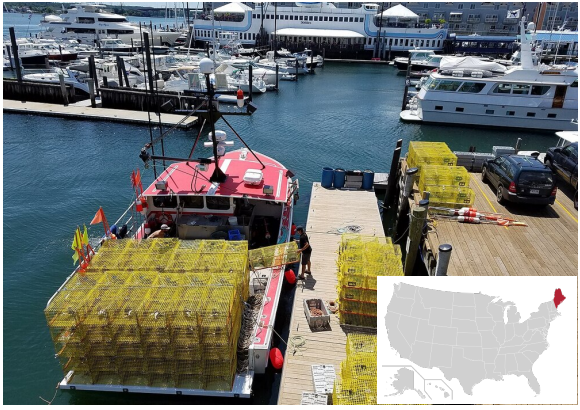
Guess: more or less recently than the last state?

State by State

Maine

- 1.4 million people
- The oldest state
- Rural, 90% white
- Never voted for Trump statewide

Guess the year



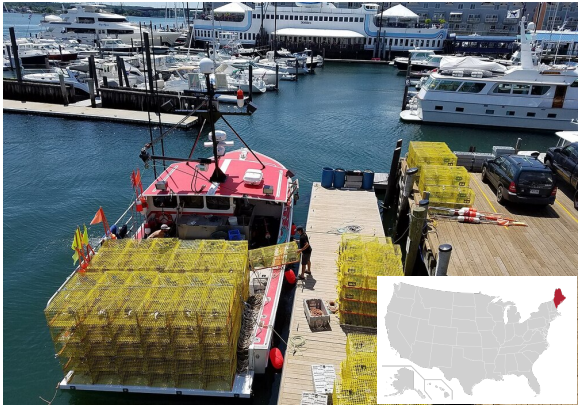
Source: US Census Bureau. Photo: Bd2media, CC BY-SA 4.0.

Maine

- 1.4 million people
- The oldest state
- Rural, 90% white
- Never voted for Trump statewide

Guess the year

1988



Source: US Census Bureau. Photo: Bd2media, CC BY-SA 4.0.

Maine: the race



Troy Jackson (D)

logger



Susan Collins (R)

senator since 1997

Top issues: health care, pensions

Jackson 53% Collins 47%

As of Nov. 12, unofficial (AP). Issues: CBS exit poll.

Why not Platner?

- Won the Democratic primary
- Old Reddit posts found:
  - "all cops are bastards"
  - joined the Marines "to have an adventure and kill some people"
- July: accused of rape (he denies it)
- He quit; Democrats chose Jackson



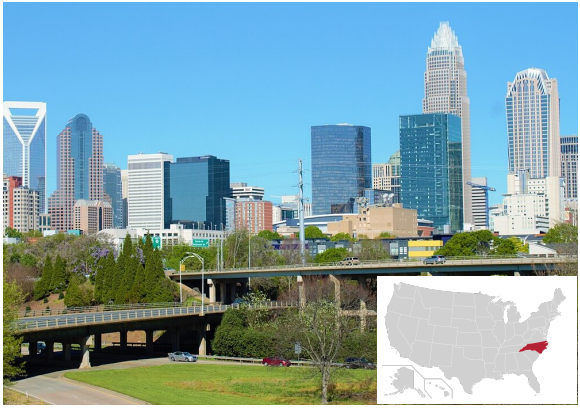
Graham Platner

Source: CNN; Politico. Photo: MAINEiac4434, CC BY-SA 4.0.

North Carolina

- 11 million people, growing fast
- 1 in 5 is Black
- Banks, universities, tech
- A swing state: Obama 2008, then Trump

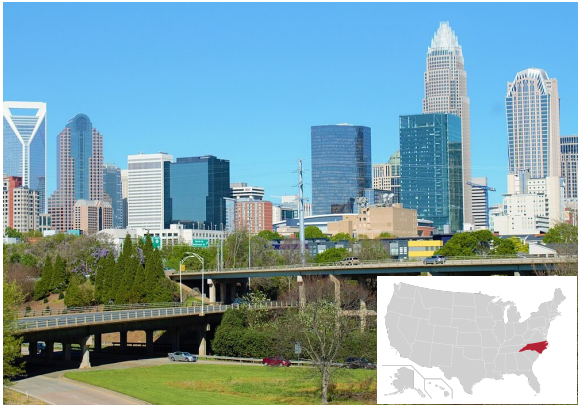
More or less recently than Maine?



Source: US Census Bureau. Photo: Charlotte (brandon walker, CC0).

North Carolina

- 11 million people, growing fast
- 1 in 5 is Black
- Banks, universities, tech
- A swing state: Obama 2008, then Trump



More or less recently than Maine?

More: 2008

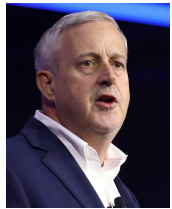
Source: US Census Bureau. Photo: Charlotte (brandon walker, CC0).

North Carolina: the race



Roy Cooper (D)

former governor



Michael Whatley (R)

Trump's party chairman

Top issues: health care, Cooper's record as governor

Cooper 59% Whatley 39%

As of Nov. 12, unofficial (AP). Issues: Searchlight poll. Photos: NCDOT, CC BY 2.0; Gage Skidmore, CC BY-SA 2.0.

Texas

- 31 million people
- 40% Hispanic
- Long border with Mexico
- Issues: immigration, the economy

More or less recently than North Carolina?



Source: US Census Bureau. Photo: border wall in the Rio Grande Valley (US Customs and Border Protection).

Texas

- 31 million people
- 40% Hispanic
- Long border with Mexico
- Issues: immigration, the economy

More or less recently than North Carolina?

Less: 1988



Source: US Census Bureau. Photo: border wall in the Rio Grande Valley (US Customs and Border Protection).

Texas: the race



James Talarico (D)

former teacher



Ken Paxton (R)

Texas Attorney General

Top issues: immigration, the border

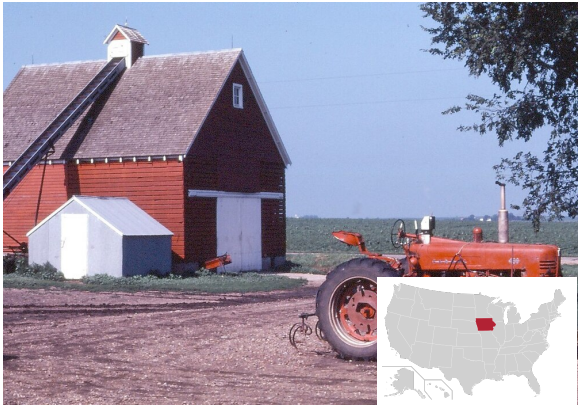
Talarico 55% Paxton 43%

As of Nov. 12, unofficial (AP). Issues: Searchlight poll. Photos: Antonioaesparza, CC BY-SA 4.0; Gage Skidmore, CC BY-SA 2.0.

Iowa

- 3 million people
- Mostly white farmers
- Number one for corn and pork
- Diesel prices matter

More or less recently than Texas?



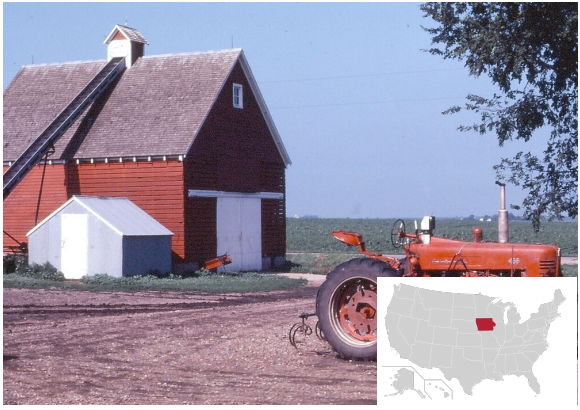
Source: US Census Bureau; USDA. Photo: inkknife_2000, CC BY-SA 2.0.

Iowa

- 3 million people
- Mostly white farmers
- Number one for corn and pork
- Diesel prices matter

More or less recently than Texas?

More: 2008



Source: US Census Bureau; USDA. Photo: inkknife_2000, CC BY-SA 2.0.

Iowa: the race



Josh Turek (D)

Paralympic champion



Ashley Hinson (R)

congresswoman

Top issues: farm incomes, diesel prices

Turek 51% Hinson 46%

As of Nov. 12, unofficial (AP). Photos: Iowa General Assembly; Office of Rep. Hinson.

South Carolina

- 5.5 million people
- 26% Black (Texas: 13%)
- Religious and conservative
- Republican since 1980

More or less recently than Iowa?



Source: US Census Bureau. Photo: Rainbow Row, Charleston (Thomson200, CC0).

South Carolina

- 5.5 million people
- 26% Black (Texas: 13%)
- Religious and conservative
- Republican since 1980

More or less recently than Iowa?

Less: 1998



Source: US Census Bureau. Photo: Rainbow Row, Charleston (Thomson200, CC0).

South Carolina: the race



Annie Andrews (D)

children's doctor



Darline Graham (R)

Lindsey Graham's sister

Senator Lindsey Graham died in July

Top issues: Graham's lack of experience

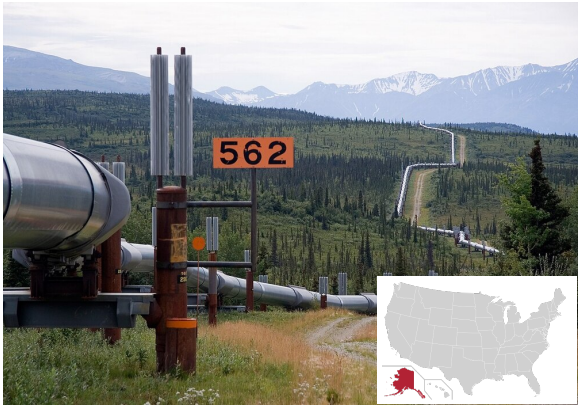
Andrews 51% Graham 47%

As of Nov. 12, unofficial (AP). Photos: Jeremy Lauten, CC0; US Senate.

Alaska

- Only 740,000 people
- The biggest state
- 1 in 5 is Alaska Native
- Oil pays for everything

More or less recently than South Carolina?



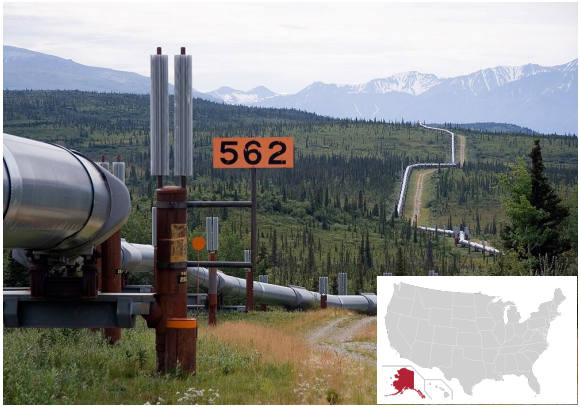
Source: US Census Bureau. Photo: Trans-Alaska Pipeline (Luca Galuzzi, CC BY-SA 2.5).

Alaska

- Only 740,000 people
- The biggest state
- 1 in 5 is Alaska Native
- Oil pays for everything

More or less recently than South Carolina?

More: 2008



Source: US Census Bureau. Photo: Trans-Alaska Pipeline (Luca Galuzzi, CC BY-SA 2.5).

Alaska: the race



Mary Peltola (D)



Dan Sullivan (R)
senator

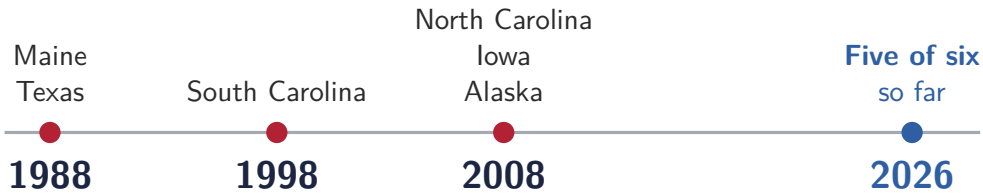


Dan Sullivan
retired teacher

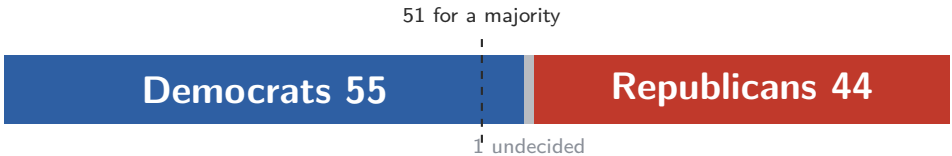
- **Top issues:** oil prices, fishing
- Two Dan Sullivans on the ballot
- Still counting: Peltola ahead by 2,500 votes
- Final count: November 18

Source: Alaska Beacon, Nov. 9. Not final. Photos: US House of Representatives; US Senate.

When did they last elect a Democrat?



The new Senate



- Before: Republicans 53, Democrats 47
- Democrats flipped 8 seats
- Number one issue everywhere: the cost of living

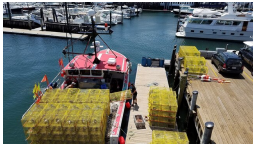
Source: AP; CBS News, as of Nov. 12. The 55 includes two independents. Issue: NBC and CBS exit polls.

Output Practice

You are the new senator

- Each table is one state
- Something goes wrong in America
- Your state votes: yes or no?
- Tell us why

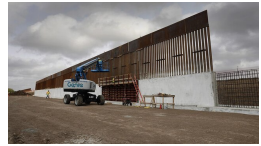
Your state at a glance



Maine
old, rural



North Carolina
swing state, growing



Texas
border, oil, 40% Hispanic



Iowa
farmers, diesel



South Carolina
conservative, 26% Black



Alaska
oil pays for everything

Scenario 1: the fire

A huge fire destroys half of America's oil

Petrol now costs three times as much

Do you vote to buy oil from Russia?

Scenario 2: the robots

A company invents a robot farmer

Food gets cheaper. Farm workers lose their jobs

Do you vote to ban the robot?

Scenario 3: the birthday

Americans now live to 100

The pension money is running out

Do you vote to raise the retirement age to 80?